

3. What if you fail?

Now that you have the list of individuals or institutions whom you know can cause harm to your data or integrity of computer system, it is time to gauge the extent of damage that they can cause to your information if they somehow manage to get into the data storage system that you have deployed. If a stronger agency is after your data, they may have stronger and more thorough means of looking into and through your data. Weigh your options and write them down. This is a very important step, because it will help you later to track down the source of the information leak or data breach if it happens, and you are on the receiving end of things.

4. How prepared should you be?

The likeliness of the attack or breach is something also worth looking at. Say if you live in a place or are on a super high security internet network, you might not need to be worried about the risks, as much as someone who has to access the internet more often than not on shady connections. Also, the level of importance of information that you carry along with you would also define the level of security and preparedness that you can have. Every individual might have their own outlook towards a threat, and for each one of them, every type of threat would fall in a different level of preparedness that they would have for it.

5. The resources you're willing to devote towards data protection

The last question that you need to answer while formulating your very own data protection plan is the time and resources that you have to devote towards data protection. In case of limited resources, you need to make sure you spread it well. You also would need to look into the resources that your storage solution has to spare for protection programs. Do not overload your system with protection software, or measures. Because in certain cases, they might as well cancel each other out, and make your computer potentially more prone to attacks and be a beacon for attracting attention of potential attackers towards your system. Sometimes it is okay to be low-key and do the bare minimum.

Having done all of this, what you would need to do is, make sure that you make this a regular practice. Depending upon the work that you do, you should make sure that all the data that you cycle through is well protected, and this security audit of sorts is at least an annual practice. Do it at least once a year to know where you stand. And, when in doubt, look